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ICE can't find freed detainee wanted on homicide warrant

US didn't tell judge about it at time of release

By Christopher Gavin
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — US District Court Judge Melissa R. DuBose would have made a different decision about releasing an ICE detainee if she had known he was wanted on a murder charge in his home country, she said this week.

At the time, Bryan Rafael Gómez, a 27-year-old undocumented immigrant who resides in Massachusetts, had a homicide warrant in the Dominican Republic. But it is not DuBose's decision, rather it's the government's role that has become an issue in Gómez's release.

Days earlier, on April 30, the US Department of Homeland Security publicly slammed the judge's decision to release Gómez from the custody of US Immigration and Customs En-

RELEASE, Page A7

'Abortion will continue to be safe, legal, and accessible. We'll never back down.'

GOVERNOR MAURA HEALEY

Tense wait for abortion ruling

As high court weighs medication access, state urges people to prepare

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

The abortion pill, which accounts for half of abortions nationwide, is widely available in Massachusetts for now. It's also, as one attorney active in the abortion debate put it, in "no man's land."

But come 5 p.m. Monday, the US Supreme Court, which temporarily restored broader access to the abortion medica-

tion mifepristone, may decide whether to stay the course or permanently ban distribution of the widely used pill through the mail with a telehealth prescription, instead of through an in-person visit to a doctor.

That's when a temporary stay on a lower court's ruling limiting access to the pill expires. With that looming deadline, the uncertainty over how a conservative Supreme Court

may rule is especially acute in Massachusetts, which has become a national hub for abortion care that relies heavily on mailing the medication to patients.

On Friday, Governor Maura Healey, backed by medical providers and activists, encouraged people to consider stocking up on abortion medicines just in case.

"We don't know what the Supreme Court is going to do," said Healey. "But I can tell you, whatever the Supreme Court does and however they rule, I'm

going to make sure as governor that we are doing everything we can to ensure that women . . . have access to the care they need."

The Supreme Court's stoppage temporarily put on hold a federal appeals court ruling that would sharply restrict access to the abortion pill. That lower court ruled that mailing the medication violated federal law, siding with Louisiana officials who challenged a federal regulation that allowed people to receive a prescription

ABORTION, Page A6



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

FOR OLD TIMES' SAKE

Red Sox legends and Baseball Hall of Famers (from left) David Ortiz, Pedro Martinez, Wade Boggs, Jim Rice, Carlton Fisk, and Carl Yastrzemski threw out ceremonial pitches before Friday's game that marked the 125th anniversary of the team's first home game. Friday night, the Sox shut out the Rays, 2-0.

C1, C5.

State seeks tighter e-bike rules; riders of all kinds say, 'Yes, please'

By Lauren Albano
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Christopher Schmidt, 41, called his first e-bike ride in 2021 a "transformative experience," a way to reach new parts of the city and break less of a sweat. He let everyone and their mother take a spin on his e-bike, convinced his friends to buy their own, and now has a collection of about 30 e-bikes in his "lending library."

"The experience that I had on an e-bike just feels like magic," Schmidt said. "It brings a lot

of the joy that you had of riding a bike when you were 7 years old."

After Governor Maura Healey announced new rules to regulate e-bikes this week, Schmidt said he was "happy to see Massachusetts taking the bull by the horns," bringing some order to the roads.

On Monday, Healey filed the Ride Safe Act — a collection of rules to regulate where and how e-bikes, mopeds, and scooters can operate. The proposed legislation would regu-

late devices based on speed capability rather than device type.

The new legislation builds on recommendations from a statewide commission, prohibiting higher-speed devices from zipping down sidewalks, bike lanes, and other high-risk areas, while increasing enforcement. Moped use would be restricted to riders ages 16 and older.

"Micromobility is already a part of how people get to work, school, and around their com-

E-BIKES, Page A10

Hacky sack? Really? Teens again get kick out of playing.

Revival takes surprising hold at high schools

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

On a recent day, Bill Silva was walking down the hallway at East Bridgewater Junior/Senior High School, where he is the principal, when he came across a group of students doing something shocking: playing hacky sack.

"I said, 'What are you *doing*?' And they said, 'We're #1 in the MIAA rankings!'" Silva recalled. "So I was like, 'What MIAA rankings? What are you talking about?'"

There was a lot to catch him up on, and it's happening incredibly fast, but here's the gist.

Since the day students returned from April vacation, hacky sack has become a phenomenon at Massachusetts high schools. And just to be clear, we're referring to April in the year 2026.

"I've never seen something explode as quickly as this," said Jason Gallagher, the

headmaster at Boston Latin School, whose sack team is #32 in the latest "MIAA Hacky Sack" rankings. We'll get to those rankings in a moment.

But first, let's address the question all the Gen X parents and teachers are asking: What the heck is happening, and why are they not on their phones?

It's kind of hard to say, but the short answer is that there was a tiny little spark before April break, a few TikTok and Instagram videos, which led many kids to ask their parents if they had a hacky sack, and parents responded: "Yes, it's in a box with my Grateful Dead bootlegs and my, um. . . . Actually, don't go in that box. I'll get it."

Perhaps. But what definitely happened is that when classes resumed on April 27, ba-boom!

HACKY SACK, Page A10



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Needham High school student Bennett Christie prepared to catch a hacky sack on the brim of his baseball cap.



Making the grayed

Saturday: Cloudy, rainy. High: 54-59. Low: 50-55.
Sunday: Warmer, some sun. High: 69-74. Low: 49-54.
Comics and Weather, **D4-5**.
Obituaries, **C9**.

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Virginia's top court struck down a congressional map drawn by Democrats and approved by voters, dealing a major blow to the party as it struggles to keep pace with Republicans. **A2.**

A three-day cease-fire agreement between Russia and Ukraine announced by President Trump defused tensions over a prospective Ukrainian attack on a Red Square parade in Moscow, but appeared unlikely to set the stage for a peace deal. **A3.**

The Croft School will close its Boston locations at the end of the academic year, said administrators of the private, for-profit elementary school whose founder was accused of fraud. **B1.**

A \$29 million renovation of St. Francis House, New England's largest day shelter, is complete after two years. **D1.**

The Fleet fell to the Ottawa Charge, 2-1, and trail in their best-of-five Walter Cup semifinal series, 2-1. **C1.**

America's employers delivered a surprising 115,000 new jobs last month despite an economic shock from the Iran war. **D1.**

Federal prosecutors filed more charges against a state lawmaker from Cape Cod they accused of stealing cash from a former employer, alleging he took thousands more than he was originally charged with. **B1.**